Hifi Micromatic

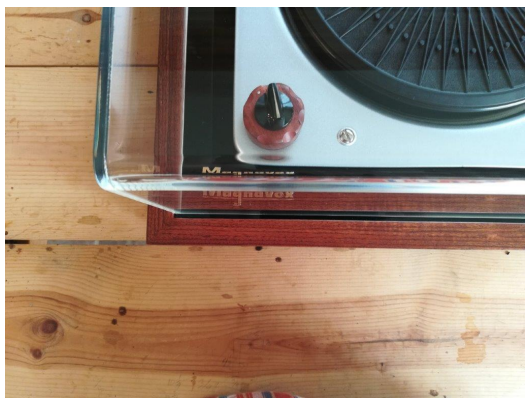
Magnavox Micromatic: Dust Cover

by Scorron82 | 2 Comments

Having no place to put my roughly 50lb, 2′ x 2′ turntable, it has been living on the floor of my den, and needless to say, has been collecting dust – the arch-nemesis of vinyl. I decided it required some manner of dust cover.

I have worked with acrylic quite a bit over the years – sawing, routing, sanding, gluing, etc. – but the prospect of putting together a clear acrylic box this size filled me with no joy. While I am confident I could have done it, I know that without a table saw I would have spent a lot of time truing edges with a piece of sandpaper glued to plate glass (an old trick for getting very straight surfaces). I also calculated the cost of the materials: I'd need about 8 sq-ft of 3/16″ acrylic, the proper glue (Weld-on 4 is recommended), an applicator, sandpaper, and I'd have to build a jig for gluing the pieces at perfect right angles. The cost was going to be $60+ for the materials alone. So I opted to buy one.

A quick Google search turns up many companies who will quote a custom acrylic box. I contacted two and the quickest to respond (and cheapest) was JMK Displays. Their communication was excellent, and the quality of the cover is just as professional. The front and back edge are bent into smooth, tight radius curves, and the sides welded on at 90 degrees. Measurrements are exactly what was provided and the fit is perfect. I am very pleased with the result.



I would have liked to build every piece of this turntable myself, but it just wasn't worth it to me, and life's too short to spend on things that don't give you any kind of satisfaction. I knew that I'd spend nearly as much money on materials and several hours building what amounts to something that should ideally be invisible. I'll leave that to a professional.

Tags: dust cover, Magnavox, Turntable

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Will February 19, 2022at10:07 pm Reply

Found your website by accident.....related to info about Magnavox record changers. Your custom model is very nice.
I jumped around thru your pages and find it all interesting. I used to work at a state university in the IT department so I find it interesting that is your day job.
Have you made any videos of your projects? I would love to see some of the electrical devices in action.
The symbols you use on your home page remind me of MYST.
I restore electro-mechanical pinball machines and now I'm restoring some radio-phono consoles. The record changers are quite marvelous devices. I'm no audiophile and I like to enjoy the action of the changers and find it more fun to not hear side two immediately after side one. Mix it up. Pink Floyd needs spin time with Fleetwood Mac.

Cheers

in Muscle Shoals, AL

scorron82 February 20, 2022at8:42 pm Reply

Thanks, Will! I'm happy that people are finding my website and enjoying the projects I share.

I took some low-res videos of my electrical devices in the past, but I think it's time for some new ones. I'll work on that.

I agree that the record changers were marvelous in their original form. The more sophisticated ones – like the Magnavox Micromatic – were works of true mechanical genius. They were practically automata.

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